GlucoTwin

Personalized glucose forecasting between clinic visits

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Digital Twin Challenge 2026 · Happiest Health
Student research prototype — not a medical device

The problem: what happens between appointments

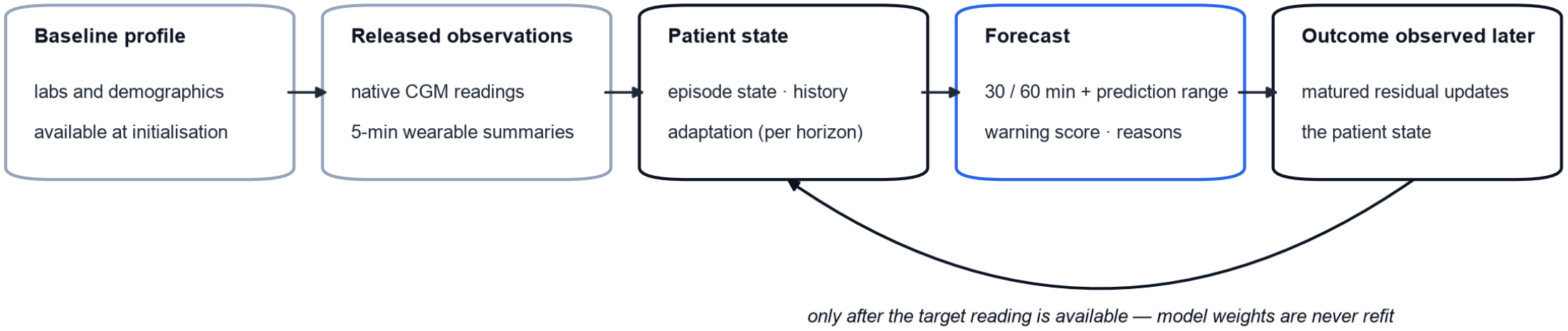
- HbA1c summarises ~3 months of glucose; it cannot show short high-glucose excursions (NIDDK).
- WHO identifies continuity of care and diabetes monitoring as ongoing challenges in India.
- Continuous glucose monitors produce ~288 readings a day — too many to review by hand.
- Question for the clinician: “Which monitored patient’s glucose pattern merits review, and what observations support that?”
- Our target: forecast glucose 30 and 60 minutes ahead and warn of a NEW sustained episode > 180 mg/dL (≥ 15 min), for Type 2 diabetes.

Use case and boundaries

- Hypothetical example (an illustration, not a deployment): a diabetes educator in Mumbai follows adults with Type 2 diabetes who wear CGMs between quarterly visits, and opens one person's replay to see forecasts, warnings and the data behind them.
- User: a clinician reviewing a small monitored cohort; secondary user: a reviewer inspecting evidence.
- Workflow (proposed): baseline labs at a visit → CGM + wearable measurements → twin forecasts → a review queue lists replays with unreviewed warnings first (an order of work, not triage) → each person reviewed in their own workspace.
- Shows: observed vs predicted glucose, uncertainty, data freshness, factual reasons, research warnings.
- Never: insulin or medication advice, triage, live device claims, LLM-generated predictions.
- Potential fit with diagnostics + outpatient services is a proposal — no partnership or pilot is claimed.

What makes it a twin (operational definition)

- Versioned patient state: baseline profile, episode state, adaptation state, issued forecasts.
- Incoming observations released by a replay clock (only what was available at that time).
- Population forecaster + patient-specific correction learned from that person’s matured forecast errors.
- Measured updates over time — a statistical research twin, not a physiological simulator.

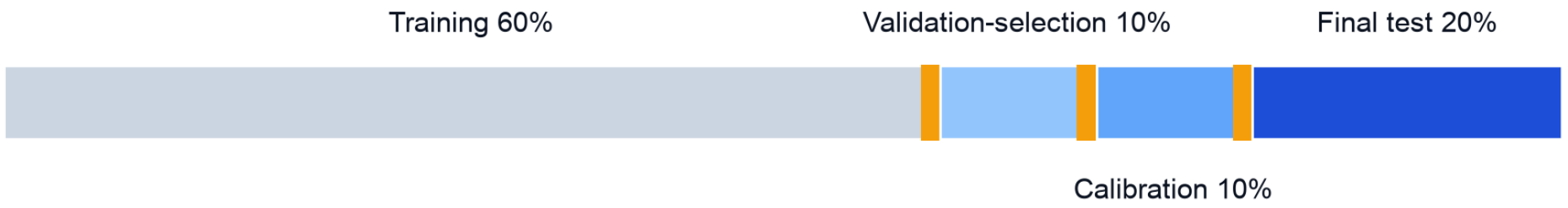


Data and provenance

- CGMacros 1.0.0 (PhysioNet, CC BY-NC-SA 4.0): 45 adults, ~10 days, Dexcom G6 Pro + Libre Pro (blinded), Fitbit, meals, screening labs.
- Primary cohort: 14 participants in the dataset's Type 2 group (HbA1c > 6.4 %); 31 others replayable but excluded.
- Finding: the published 1-minute CGM columns are linearly interpolated. We recover native 5-minute Dexcom readings (integer knots) and never count interpolated rows.
- Undocumented columns reported, not interpreted; documented error codes excluded; dates shifted; timezone unknown → synthetic clock, no time-of-day features.
- Synthetic fictional participants exercise edge cases (gaps, late meal logs, short history) with no download.

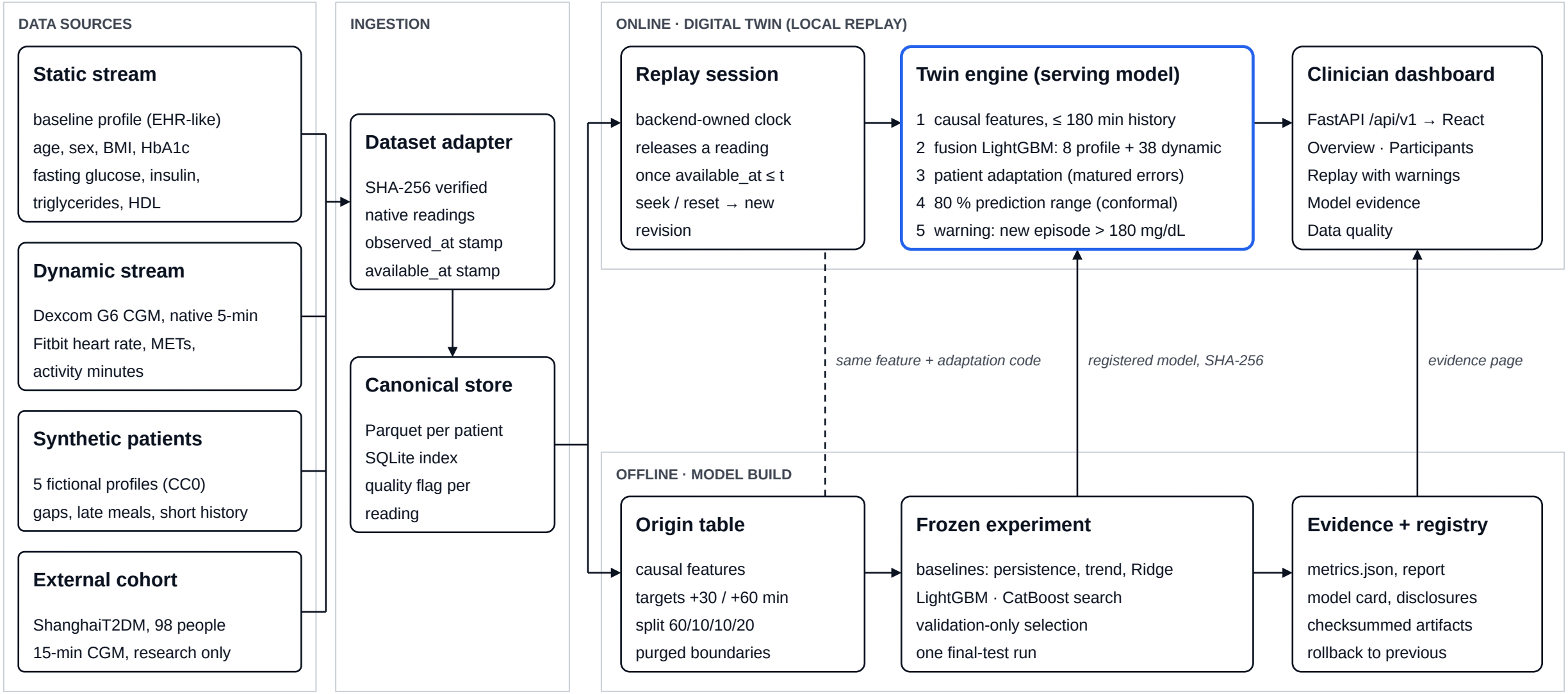
Information availability and leakage controls

- Every record carries observed_at and available_at; a forecast at t uses only records with both ≤ t.
- Meals excluded from the primary model (logging time unknown); tested separately as an optimistic sensitivity.
- Protocol frozen before fitting; model, adaptation, intervals and alert threshold chosen on validation. Results shown (gt-primary-2026-10-13-fusion) re-run gt-primary-2026-10-11-v2's protocol with one change, declared after its test segment had been inspected: the serving model must read the baseline profile and the wearable streams.
- Adaptation uses a residual only after its target reading was available; missing future data is censored, never negative.



One participant's timeline (~10 days); every participant is split the same way. Amber: purged origins whose 60-min target + 15-min confirmation would cross a boundary.

System architecture: two data streams, one twin



Solid arrow: data flow · Dashed: identical code offline and online · Blue: serving model · CPU only, runs locally, no cloud, no LLM · research prototype, not a medical device

Models and personalization

- Fusion: the serving model reads 38 dynamic features (CGM history, wearable heart rate and activity) and 8 static baseline profile values (age, sex, BMI, HbA1c, fasting glucose and insulin, triglycerides, HDL) in one model.
- Baselines: persistence, bounded linear trend, ridge regression.
- Direct per-horizon gradient-boosted trees: LightGBM (starting point) and CatBoost (challenger), equal 12-trial seeded searches, identical inputs and origins.
- Patient adaptation (same policy for both families): shrunk, bounded, decaying mean of matured residuals vs the frozen population forecast; weights never refit.
- Prediction ranges: split-conformal, target coverage 80 %, calibrated on the calibration segment for the exact serving pipeline.
- Warning: max forecast within 60 min − 180 mg/dL — an uncalibrated score, never shown as a probability.

Why this learner: validation-only selection

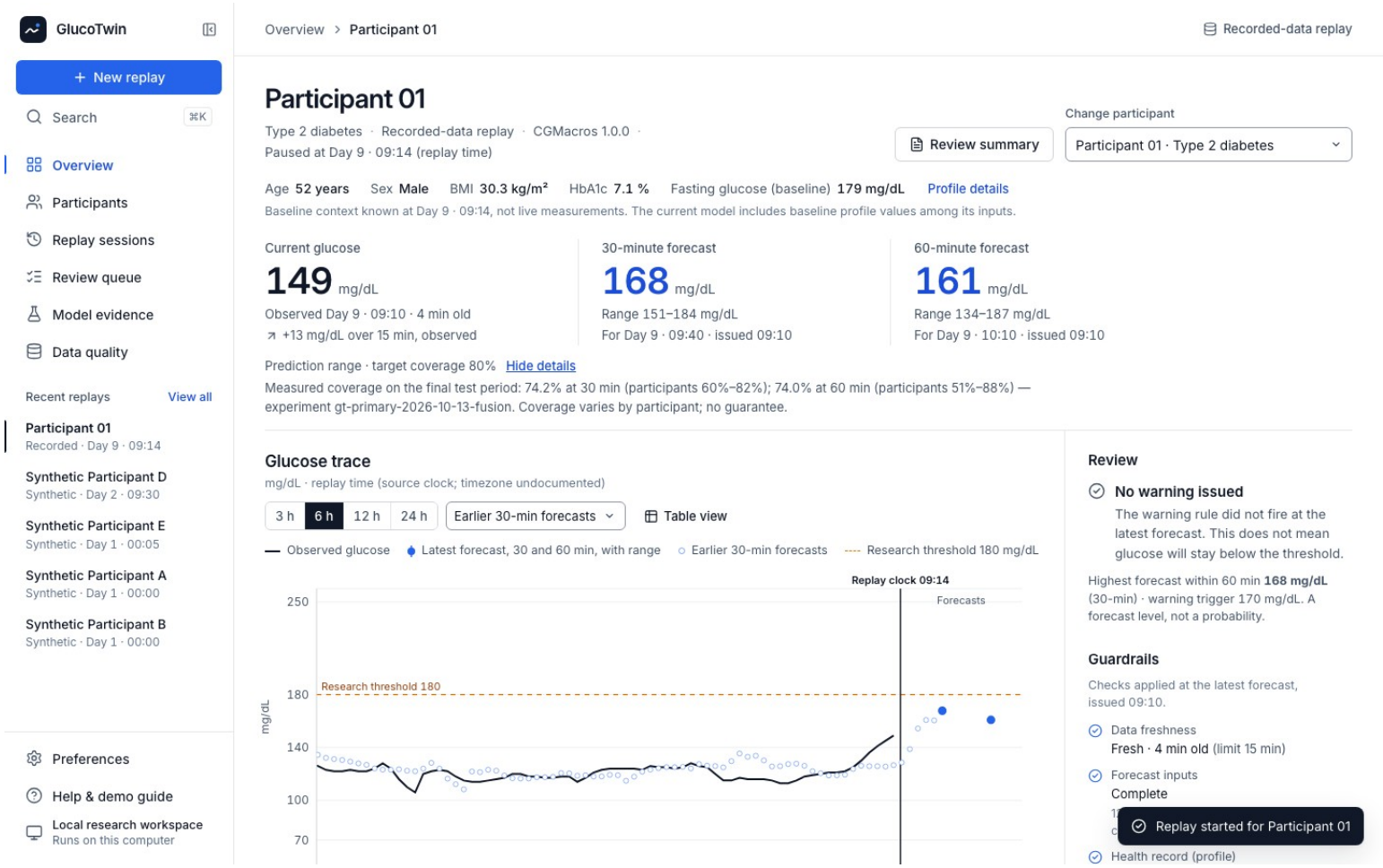
Candidate	Val. MAE 30	Val. MAE 60	Score
lightgbm:dyn-prof-v2	**13.47**	**21.26**	**17.36**
catboost:dyn-prof-v2	13.56	21.31	17.44
lightgbm:dyn-v2	13.76	21.73	17.75
catboost:dyn-v2	13.88	21.66	17.77
ridge:dyn-v2	14.13	22.44	18.28
ridge:dyn-prof-v2	14.21	22.61	18.41
linear_trend:cgm-only-v1	15.66	26.33	20.99
persistence:cgm-only-v1	16.51	26.32	21.42

Declared rule: lowest mean per-participant MAE over both horizons; candidates within 0.5 mg/dL tie → simpler family, then smaller feature set. Eligible for serving: dyn-prof-v2 only (profile + wearable), a constraint added on 2026-10-13 after the test segment had been inspected, to meet the fusion requirement. Selected: lightgbm:dyn-prof-v2 with patient adaptation. Without the constraint the same rule picks lightgbm:dyn-v2 (the earlier model, gt-primary-2026-10-11-v2).

Fusion: what the profile adds, and what it does not show

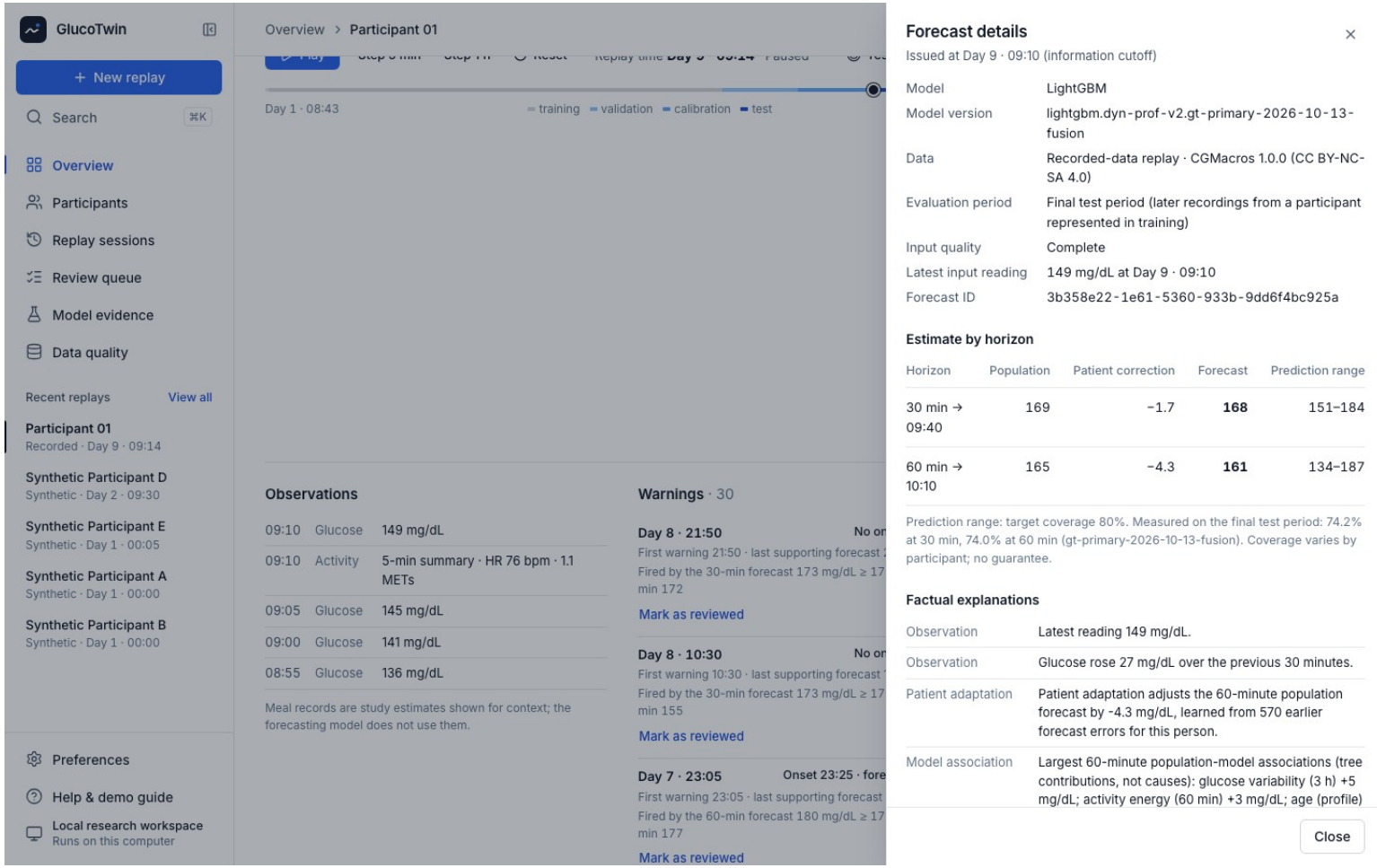
- The brief asks for a model that ingests static EHR-like data and dynamic wearable data. The demo model (LightGBM, dyn-prof-v2) reads 8 baseline profile values and 38 glucose and wearable features in one model.
- Same 14 people, later days (test): profile minus dynamic-only -0.25 mg/dL [-0.43, -0.04] at 30 min and -0.61 mg/dL [-1.15, -0.09] at 60 min (negative = profile better). Profile values are constant per person, so here they can act as an identity code.
- People held out entirely (nested experiment): +0.34 [-0.28, +0.89] mg/dL at 30 min and -0.75 [-2.19, +0.61] mg/dL at 60 min — no reliable benefit for new people.
- Selection: the v2 rule applied only to profile + wearable models — a constraint declared on 2026-10-13, after the test segment had been inspected. Test MAE 12.96 / 20.26 mg/dL vs 13.15 / 20.81 for the dynamic-only model (gt-primary-2026-10-11-v2): retrospective, same people.
- Warnings: margin re-derived by the same F1 rule (-10 vs -30 mg/dL): 1.49 vs 2.95 false alarms per observed day, 61/64 vs 64/64 onsets, forecast lead median 30 vs 55 min. A threshold trade-off, not evidence that the profile helps.
- Our claim: we selected a model that implements the required fusion; we have not established that profile features improve forecasting for unseen patients.

Clinician workflow: the twin workspace



Recorded-data replay in the final test period (later recordings of participants the model was trained on): current glucose, 30/60-minute forecasts with prediction ranges (target coverage 80 %), saved earlier forecasts, research warnings with outcomes, review status and the live safety guardrails.

Demonstration: evidence behind a forecast



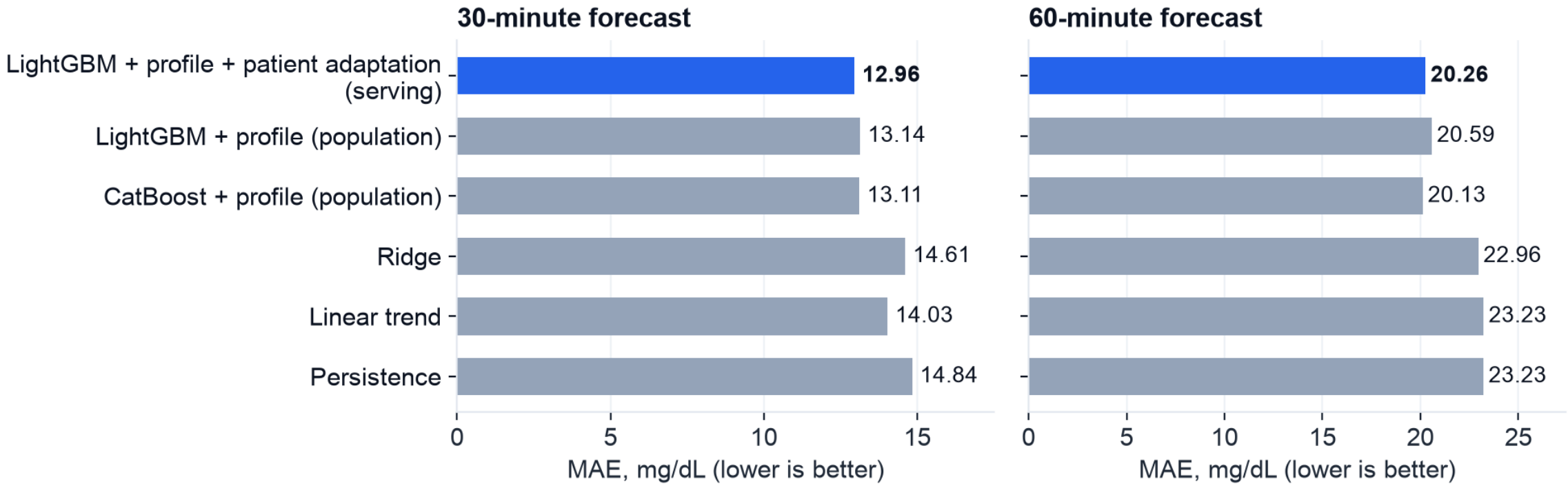
Each forecast is immutable and inspectable: information cutoff, model version, evaluation segment, population forecast vs patient correction, factual explanations.

Safety guardrails built into the twin

- Abstains instead of guessing: no forecast with under 60 min of history, a sparse last hour or no new reading; after 15 min without one the last forecast is marked Stale. Weak inputs (gaps, sensor-limit readings, missing wearable data) are flagged Degraded, with the reason.
- The fusion model abstains when a health-record value is missing or not yet available; no input is used before the time it became available (native CGM readings only).
- Personal correction bounded: learns only from forecasts whose outcome was observed, needs 6, capped at ±25 mg/dL, resets after a 3-hour gap.
- Every warning is a labelled research warning: Outcome pending until it can be judged, then matched to an onset, counted as a false alarm or marked unknown; firings within 30 min merge into one episode.
- Uncertainty and limits shown: 80 % prediction ranges with measured coverage; not a medical device, no treatment advice, replay only.
- Evaluation cannot be quietly re-run: opened tests are locked; research runs cannot change the demo model; the app reproduced all 15,440 saved test forecasts within 0.05 mg/dL.

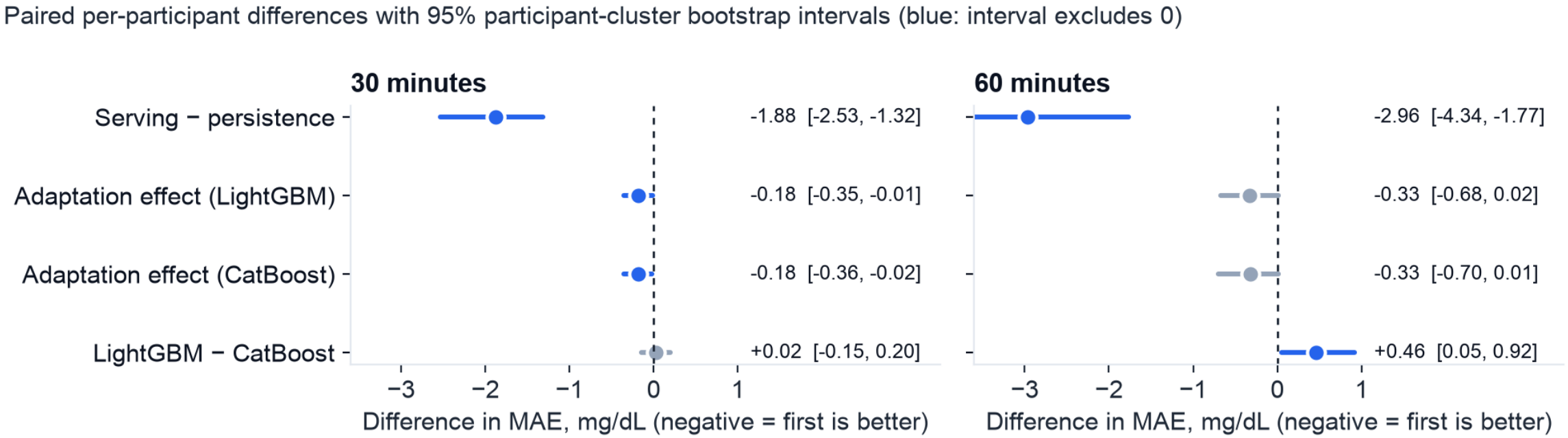
Measured evaluation: forecast accuracy (later days)

Final test, later days of the same 14 participants: macro mean of per-participant MAE



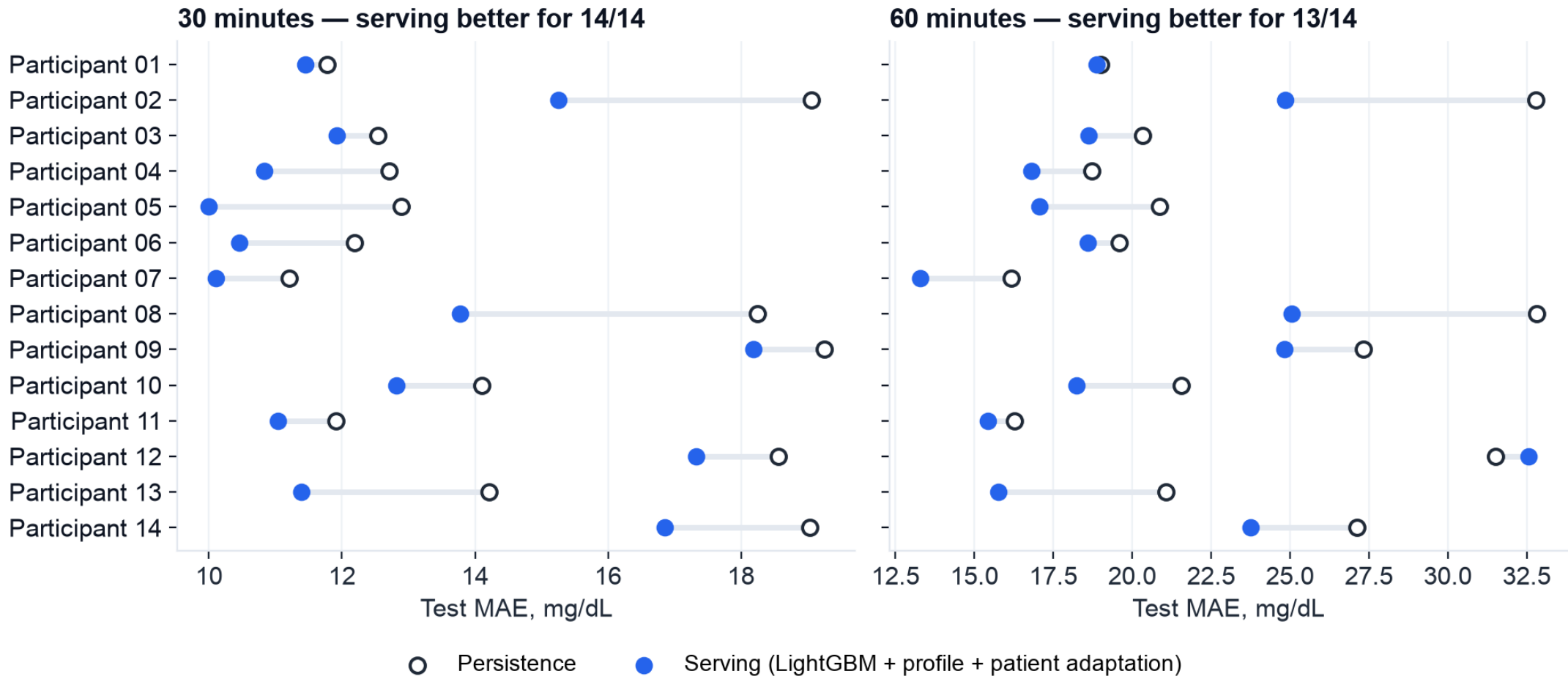
Later recordings of the same 14 participants the model was trained on — not new patients. Serving − persistence: -1.88 mg/dL [-2.53, -1.32] at 30 min, -2.96 mg/dL [-4.34, -1.77] at 60 min. Test origins 7,730 (≈ 644 h); forecasts issued for 99.9 % of origins with a target.

Measured evaluation: does personalization help?



Adaptation (LightGBM): -0.18 mg/dL [-0.35, -0.01] at 30 min, -0.33 mg/dL [-0.68, 0.02] at 60 min — small; population 13.14 / 20.59, frozen state 13.19 / 20.65, adaptive 12.96 / 20.26 mg/dL. New-participant cold start: 14.66/24.26 → 13.81/22.12 mg/dL with adaptation.

Measured evaluation: every participant



Per-participant test MAE, persistence vs the serving pipeline. Gains are uneven: large for some participants, none for a few at 60 minutes. Fourteen people cannot establish population-level performance.

Measured evaluation: early warning and uncertainty

- 60-min warning (test, margin threshold -10 mg/dL chosen on validation by F1): 61/64 new onsets detected, precision 0.60, 40 false alarms (1.49 per observed patient-day; 2.28 per eligible day); forecast lead median 30 min (episode start 30 min).
- Same procedure on persistence (fires at glucose ≥ 150): 63/64 detected, 70 false alarms (2.61 per observed patient-day; 4.00 per eligible day).
- Prediction ranges (target coverage 80 %) covered 74.2 % (30 min) and 74.0 % (60 min) on test, 60–82 % and 51–88 % per participant — under-covered; no guarantee claimed.
- Optimistic meal logging: 19.07 vs 20.59 mg/dL at 60 min — timely meal data would likely help most.

Research: new people and an independent cohort

- Models kept separate: the v2 recipe (LightGBM, dynamic streams only; the demo model when this experiment was declared), a Ridge five-minute candidate on CGM-only features, and a separate 15-minute LightGBM as the external check.
- 145 participants imported; 14 evaluated internally (five participant folds, each person held out once) and 98 evaluated externally (ShanghaiT2DM, China, opened once).
- Held-out people, 30 / 60 min: candidate 13.88 / 22.30 vs v2 recipe refit 14.52 / 24.25 vs persistence 15.34 / 24.47 mg/dL — but worse on large highs (+2.71 [+0.28, +5.11] mg/dL at 60 min when the target exceeded 180).
- Warnings chosen for ≤ 2 false alarms per day: 301/329 onsets at 1.31 false alarms per observed day (v2 recipe: 329/329 at 2.80).
- External 15-minute LightGBM vs persistence: -0.99 [-1.21, -0.77] mg/dL at 30 min (clear); -0.34 [-0.76, +0.10] mg/dL at 60 min (inconclusive).
- Not promoted, and not eligible as the demo model: the Ridge candidate reads CGM only. CGMacros was already inspected, so its folds are internal validation; the next protocol also bounds high-glucose error, missed onsets and false warnings (declared, not run).

Research: warning two hours ahead

- The brief's example is a spike predicted 2 hours ahead. Declared before any fit (decision D-043): the people-held-out procedure above, same folds, plus a 120-minute horizon. 14 people, each held out once; not the demo model, nothing promoted.
- Forecast error at 120 min: 30.6 mg/dL vs persistence 35.9 (-5.25 [-6.44, -4.05] mg/dL); at 60 min 22.3 vs 24.5.
- 120-min warning: 315/329 onsets warned, 1.62 false alarms per observed day, median forecast lead 15 min. For comparison, 60-min warning: 313/329 onsets warned, 1.48 false alarms per observed day, median forecast lead 10 min.
- Profile (EHR-like) inputs at 120 min, LightGBM with minus without: -0.86 [-2.60, +1.02] mg/dL (no reliable benefit on people held out).
- Thresholds chosen on development folds only (≤ 2 false alarms per observed day); each test fold opened once. The 14 people were inspected in earlier experiments, so this is internal validation.
- Independent cohort (98 ShanghaiT2DM people, CGM-only 15-minute model, assessed once; D-045): 29.6 vs persistence 31.7 mg/dL at 120 min (-2.12 [-2.67, -1.53]), better for 78 of 98 people.

Research: what we fixed, and what we could not

- Declared and committed before any arm was computed (D-046): the saved two-hour predictions re-analysed, every choice made on development people, the outer people read once. Same 14 already-inspected people: internal validation.
- Fixed — prediction ranges: calibrating on all development people instead of 2 per fold raised two-hour coverage from 76.5 % to 79.8 % (target 80 %; 60 min 78.2 → 79.5 %), ranges 7 mg/dL wider.
- Not shown — earlier warning: 126 vs 123 of 329 onsets warned ≥ 30 min ahead (+0.9 points [-5.5, +6.6]) at the same workload; median lead still 15 min.
- Not shown — health record as a new person's starting correction: -0.53 [-1.57, +0.58] mg/dL at 120 min, -0.93 [-2.74, +0.48] in the first 24 hours; the intervals cross zero, so no benefit is claimed.
- The demo model's ranges are already pooled over all 14 people; its under-coverage most likely comes from drift between time segments, so this fix is not applied to it.

Project outcomes

- Built: a working personalized glucose twin — replay API with a backend-owned clock, immutable forecasts, research warnings with outcomes — and a clinician workspace (landing page, Overview, Participants, Replay sessions, Model evidence, Data quality).
- Found and corrected a data-provenance problem: the published 1-minute CGM values are interpolated; only native 5-minute readings are used.
- Measured on later recordings of the same participants (retrospective): 14/14 participants improved over persistence at 30 min and 13/14 at 60 min; MAE 12.96 / 20.26 mg/dL vs 14.84 / 23.23.
- Personalization: small gains (-0.18 mg/dL and -0.33 mg/dL). Warnings: 61/64 onsets detected with 40 false alarms (1.49 per observed patient-day) — the F1 threshold rule ignores review workload.
- Corrected after an independent review (activity-window defect, online warning double-credit; gt-primary-2026-10-11-v1 preserved), then re-run with the fusion constraint (gt-primary-2026-10-13-fusion); the dynamic-only model of gt-primary-2026-10-11-v2 stays registered for rollback.
- Reproducible: synthetic mode needs no download; recorded-data results regenerate from versioned configs; a fresh copy passes the automated backend, frontend and browser tests.

Limitations

- 14 participants from one US site; overlapping windows are not independent patients.
- No Indian participants — nothing here establishes performance for patients in India.
- Blinded research CGMs replayed with assumed zero latency; native timestamps known to the minute.
- Medication and insulin use unknown; meal logging time undocumented.
- Profile fusion: profile values are constant per person, so with 14 people they can act as an identity code; no benefit was shown on people held out entirely.
- Prediction ranges under-cover; the warning score is uncalibrated and its threshold rule (F1) ignores review workload; 180 mg/dL is a research threshold, not triage.
- Retrospective replay only: no clinician workflow, outcome or safety study. Optional Chronos-Bolt not run.
- Scores depend on the dataset, prediction task and evaluation protocol; performance on simulated patients does not establish performance on real patients.

Next steps: evidence needed for Indian patients

- Prospective, consented Indian cohort with unblinded CGMs, recorded transmission latency, medications and meal logging times.
- Re-evaluate held-out participants (cold start) and per-site calibration; report subgroup performance.
- AI-READI five-minute CGM and wearable data (access not yet requested; steps listed) for a larger new-person evaluation under the declared protocol gt-nested-2026-10-12-v2.
- Clinician usability study of the review workflow; regulatory and data-protection review (DPDP Act).
- Optional: compare a fine-tuned time-series foundation model (e.g. Chronos-Bolt) under the same protocol.

Team, links, reproducibility and licenses

- Team Kryptonite — Avinash Gehi (team leader) · Hardik Hinduja. Vivekanand Education Society's Institute of Technology (VESIT), Mumbai.
- Code: public GitHub link — added after the team publishes the repository — MIT license (code only). Quick start: make setup · make synthetic · make dev.
- Demo video (at least 20 minutes): unlisted YouTube link — added after recording and upload. Architecture: docs/submission/GlucoTwin_Architecture.pdf.
- Data: CGMacros 1.0.0, Gutierrez-Osuna, Kerr, Mortazavi, Das (2025), PhysioNet, doi:10.13026/3z8q-x658, CC BY-NC-SA 4.0; ShanghaiT2DM, Zhao, Zhu, Wang, Rao (2022), figshare, doi:10.6084/m9.figshare.21600933.v5, CC BY 4.0.
- All results: experiment gt-primary-2026-10-13-fusion, artifacts/experiments/…/metrics.json; reports/evaluation_report.md.